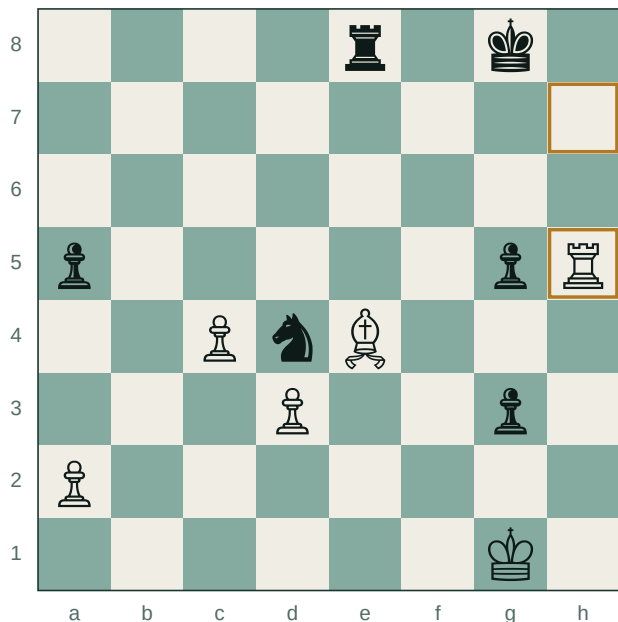


Attraction tactics: Black, move 38

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Rh5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...Ne2+ 39. Kf1 g2+ 40. Kxg2 Nf4+ 41. Kf3 Nxh5

38...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39.Kf1**.

39...g2+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **40.Kxg2**.

40...Nf4+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on g2 and rook on h5. Recorded reply: **41.Kf3**.

41...Nxh5 The knight captures the rook on h5.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on h5. Check for tactical protection.